EchoCV Recording Guide

How to record your sessions for the EchoCV dataset

> **Your participant code:** _____ **Coordinator:** _____
>
> **Shared folder:** _____

Why we record

EchoCV is our AI interview coach. To work well on a real laptop webcam, it has to learn from people like its users. Your recordings teach it to:

- spot behaviours such as **touching your face, crossing your arms, slouching and reading notes**;
- hear Indonesian filler sounds like **"eee", "hmm" and "em"**;
- check **eye contact, smiling and posture**.

No public dataset shows these from a laptop webcam, so we record our own.

At a glance

> - **3 sessions per person**, on different days, about **30 minutes** each.
> - Each session has two parts:
>   - **Part A:** 10 short clips of 30 seconds, acting out one behaviour per clip.
>   - **Part B:** 4 interview answers of 1–2 minutes, answered naturally.
> - **Rename every file** right after you record it.
> - **Upload only to the team's shared folder.** Never through WhatsApp, email or anything public.

Before your first session

- [ ] Sign the consent form (once).
- [ ] Get your participant code from the coordinator (for example `p01`).
- [ ] Read this guide once from start to finish.

1. Set up your laptop

Camera and microphone

- **Use your laptop's built-in webcam**, with the laptop on a desk where you would normally use it. That is the camera EchoCV runs on.
- Don't use a phone or a camera on a tripod. Use an external webcam only if that's what you really use for online interviews, and tell the coordinator.
- **Use the built-in microphone.** Earphones or a headset mic are fine if that's what you normally use; tell the coordinator.

Recording app

Laptop	App	Settings
Windows	**Camera** (built in), switched to **Video** mode	Settings (gear icon) › Video quality: **1080p 30 fps**, or 720p 30 fps if 1080p isn't offered. Videos are saved in Pictures › Camera Roll.
Mac	QuickTime Player › File › New Movie Recording (or Photo Booth)	Quality: High
Any	OBS Studio	MP4, 1280×720 or 1920×1080, 30 fps, audio on

Turn off all camera effects

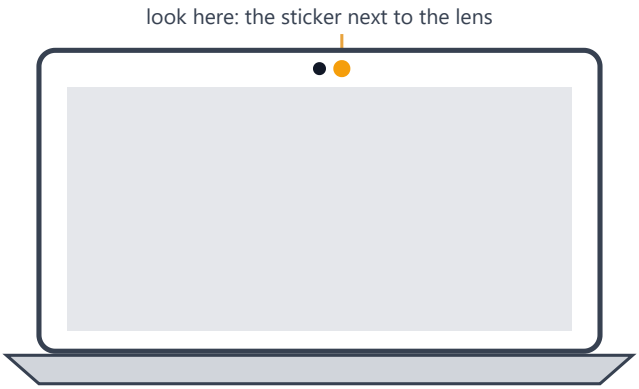
> Effects that change your face or the picture ruin the recording. **"Eye contact" correction is the worst:** it makes you look at the camera when you aren't, which is exactly what EchoCV measures.

- [ ] **Windows Studio Effects** (Settings › Bluetooth & devices › Cameras › your camera): turn off Eye contact, Background effects (blur), Automatic framing, Portrait light, Creative filters and Voice focus. Also check the Studio effects tile in Quick Settings.
- [ ] **Laptop brand camera apps** (Lenovo, ASUS, HP, Dell and others): turn off auto-framing, eye correction, beautify and background effects.
- [ ] **NVIDIA Broadcast or AMD camera effects:** turn them off or close the app.
- [ ] **Mac:** Control Center › Video Effects: turn off Center Stage, Portrait, Studio Light and Reactions.
- [ ] Close video-call apps and browser tabs that use the camera.

Framing, light and privacy



Head to mid-chest, a little space above your head.



"Look at the camera" always means the lens, not your face on the screen.

- Sit **50–80 cm** from the screen, with the screen tilted as you normally use it.
- The picture shows your **whole head down to mid-chest**. Don't zoom and don't lean in.
- Crossed arms and notes held at your chest should show at least partly at the bottom. If they don't, tilt the screen back a little once, then keep it there for the whole session.
- Put a **small sticker right next to the webcam lens** and look at it whenever you're asked to look at the camera.
- Your face must be clearly visible. A dim room or a window behind you is fine for one session at most.
- **Privacy:** no other people in view or audible, since they haven't agreed to be recorded. Nothing readable that identifies anyone: no ID or student cards, letters, or chat windows behind you.

2. Make each session different

Change **at least two** of these between sessions. A model that only ever sees one room and one shirt learns that room and that shirt.

	Session 1	Session 2	Session 3
Day	Day 1	Another day	Another day
Place	Bedroom or study desk	Another room (living room, kos common area, a friend's desk)	Campus or library, in a quiet corner with nobody behind you
Light	Daylight from the front	Evening, ceiling lamp or a desk lamp from the side	Whatever is there; dimmer is fine
Clothes	T-shirt	Shirt or batik	Jacket, hoodie or a different colour
Glasses, cap or head covering	As usual	Switch if you can (glasses on/off)	As usual
Chair	Desk chair	A different chair or stool	Whatever is there

3. Before you press record (every session)

- [ ] Laptop plugged in, on a desk, screen at its normal angle.
- [ ] All camera effects off.
- [ ] Sticker next to the lens; the picture shows head to mid-chest.
- [ ] Quiet room, nobody else in view, phone on silent.
- [ ] Props within reach: a sheet of paper with notes (print or copy the question list, nothing personal), your phone, and a book or notebook.
- [ ] A 3-second test video plays back with sound. Delete it afterwards.

4. Part A: 10 behaviour clips

1. Press record and sit still for **2 seconds**.
2. Do the behaviour for **30 seconds** (watch the app's timer).
    - **Keep talking the whole time:** describe your day, explain a recipe, or count slowly. Your mouth moves in a real interview, so it should here too.
    - **Change the variation every ~5 seconds:** other hand, higher, lower, stronger, weaker. Thirty seconds of one frozen pose teaches EchoCV only one picture.
3. Stop, then **rename the file straight away** (see section 6).

> **One behaviour per clip.** The file name tells EchoCV what is in the clip, so a mixed clip teaches it the wrong thing. If you mix by mistake, delete the clip and record it again.

#	File name	Do (switch between these)	Don't
1	`upright`	Sit up straight but relaxed, as in a good interview. Look at the sticker most of the time; a short glance away is natural. Neutral, friendly face.	Don't slouch, cross your arms, touch your face or hold anything. Don't force a big smile.

#	File name	Do (switch between these)	Don't
2	`looking_away`	Keep sitting upright but look **away from the lens**: at your face on the screen, the keyboard, left, right, up as if thinking, at the door. Switch every 3–5 seconds.	Don't look at the lens. Don't touch your face.
3	`smile`	Talk about something pleasant while looking at the lens. Smile naturally: small closed-mouth smile, open smile with teeth, a short laugh.	Don't cover your mouth or touch your face.
4	`gestures`	Explain something with your hands: count on your fingers, open palms, point, draw shapes in the air. Hands may come **near** your face (pointing at yourself, a wave).	Don't let your hands **touch** your face or neck. Don't cross your arms.
5	`desk_hands`	Hands busy below your face: clasped on the desk, typing, holding or clicking a pen, hand on the mouse, hands in your lap, forearms resting on the desk.	Don't hold paper, a phone or a book. Don't cross your arms or slouch.
6	`touching_face`	Chin resting on your hand (the "thinking" pose), touch or scratch your nose, cheek on your palm, hand over your mouth, rub an eye, touch your temple or forehead, adjust your glasses, touch your neck or throat. Switch hands.	Don't hold one touch for the whole clip. Don't cross your arms or slouch while doing it.
7	`arms_crossed`	Classic crossed arms with hands tucked in, crossed high near the chest, low and loose near the stomach, hugging yourself (hands on opposite upper arms), one arm across your body holding the other arm. Keep looking at the lens and talking.	Don't touch your face. Don't slouch heavily (a little lean back is fine).
8	`slouching`	Slide down in the chair, round your shoulders and let your chest sink, push your head and chin forward toward the screen, lean forward on your forearms, lean back lazily, lean to one side. Go from mild to strong.	Keep your hands away from your face. Don't cross your arms or hold anything.
9	`reading_notes_held`	Hold the paper, phone or book **in front of your chest** so it shows in the picture. Read from it, look down, look up at the lens, look back down, turn a page, switch objects.	Don't hold it at your ear (a phone call isn't reading). Don't hide your face behind it.
10	`reading_notes_desk`	Put your notes flat on the desk or keyboard, **below the picture**. Read your answer from them as if cheating in an interview: look down, read a line, look up, look down again.	Don't hold the notes up. Don't rest your chin on your hand.

Clip 10 shows no notes on purpose. It teaches EchoCV to notice when your eyes keep dropping to notes.

5. Part B: 4 interview answers

> **Be yourself here.** Don't act out behaviours and don't hide them. If you normally say "eee", touch your chin or cross your arms, that's fine. These answers show how EchoCV does in a real interview.

For each answer:

1. Read the question on your screen. Take a few seconds to think if you like.
2. Press record and look at the lens for **2 seconds**.

3. Answer in **1–2 minutes**, talking to the lens as if the interviewer were behind it. No script and no reading. "Eee", "hmm" and pauses are fine; they're exactly what we need.
4. Stop and rename the file.

- **Language:** answer most questions in Indonesian. If you're comfortable, answer one per session in English. Mixing Indonesian and English naturally is fine.
- **Keep it private:** no real names (yours or anyone else's), addresses, phone numbers, NIK, student numbers or company secrets. Say "teman saya" or "dosen saya" instead of names. Making up details is fine; it's practice.
- **Which questions:** session 1 answers **q01–q04**, session 2 answers **q05–q08**, session 3 answers **q09–q12**.

Code	Bahasa Indonesia	English
q01	Perkenalkan diri Anda dan ceritakan latar belakang pendidikan Anda.	Introduce yourself and your educational background.
q02	Mengapa Anda tertarik bekerja di bidang IT?	Why do you want to work in IT?
q03	Ceritakan proyek paling menantang yang pernah Anda kerjakan. Apa peran Anda dan bagaimana hasilnya?	Tell me about the most challenging project you have worked on. What was your role and what was the result?
q04	Ceritakan saat Anda berbeda pendapat dengan anggota tim. Bagaimana Anda menyelesaikannya?	Tell me about a time you disagreed with a teammate. How did you resolve it?
q05	Ceritakan pengalaman ketika Anda gagal atau melakukan kesalahan. Apa yang Anda pelajari?	Tell me about a time you failed or made a mistake. What did you learn?
q06	Bagaimana Anda menangani tenggat waktu yang sangat ketat dengan banyak tugas sekaligus?	How would you handle a very tight deadline with several tasks at once?
q07	Ceritakan bagaimana Anda mempelajari teknologi baru dalam waktu singkat.	Tell me how you learned a new technology in a short time.
q08	Apa kelebihan dan kekurangan terbesar Anda?	What are your greatest strengths and weaknesses?
q09	Jelaskan perbedaan database SQL dan NoSQL, dan kapan Anda memilih masing-masing.	Explain the difference between SQL and NoSQL databases and when you would choose each.
q10	Jelaskan apa yang terjadi ketika Anda mengetik alamat sebuah situs web di browser.	Explain what happens when you type a website address into a browser.
q11	Aplikasi yang Anda buat tiba-tiba error di production. Apa langkah-langkah Anda?	An app you built suddenly fails in production. What do you do?
q12	Di mana Anda melihat diri Anda lima tahun ke depan?	Where do you see yourself in five years?

6. Name your files

Rename each file **as soon as you stop recording**. Windows Camera names files by time (`WIN_20261012_14_33_10_Pro.mp4`), and after ten clips you won't know which is which.

```
Part A:  code_session_clip                          → p01_s1_upright.mp4
Part B:  code_session_answerNN_question_language → p01_s1_answer01_q01_id.mp4
```

What	Example	Notes
Part A clip	`p01_s1_arms_crossed.mp4`	Clip name exactly as in the Part A table
Part B answer in Indonesian	`p01_s1_answer01_q01_id.mp4`	answer01, answer02, … count within the session
Part B answer in English	`p01_s1_answer04_q03_en.mp4`	Language: **id**, **en**, or **mix**
Recorded on a Mac	`p01_s2_slouching.mov`	Keep the .mov ending; don't convert

- **Retakes:** delete the bad take and keep only the final one under the normal name. No "_v2" or "_final".
- **Folders:** one folder per session, inside a folder with your code (for example **p01 › s1**). Put that session's 10 clips and 4 answers in it, and nothing else.

7. Send your session details

After each session, send the coordinator these details. A chat message is fine (text only, never the videos).

Detail	Example
Date	14 October 2026
Place	bedroom desk
Light	daylight from the front
Clothes	black T-shirt
Glasses, cap or head covering	glasses, no cap
Laptop model	ASUS TUF F15
Video quality	1080p
Microphone	built-in
All camera effects off?	yes
What you recorded	10 clips, 4 answers
Anything unusual	fan noise; arms partly out of the picture in arms_crossed

8. Check before you upload

Re-record instead of trimming or editing. Editing apps re-encode the video and can shift the sound.

- [ ] Every file plays to the end **with sound**.
- [ ] Part A clips are at least 32 seconds (2 seconds still + 30 seconds). Answers are 1–2 minutes.
- [ ] Your whole face is in the picture the whole time (brief turns are fine).
- [ ] File names follow the pattern exactly; 10 clips and 4 answers in the session folder.
- [ ] Nobody else is visible or audible, and nothing identifying is readable.
- [ ] Camera effects were off (the background is sharp, not blurred).
- [ ] Each Part A clip shows only its own behaviour.

9. Upload

- Upload the whole session folder to the **team's shared folder** (link from the coordinator).
- **Never** send recordings through WhatsApp, Telegram or other chat apps (they shrink the video and leave copies on phones), by email, to GitHub, or through any public link or social media.
- Once the coordinator confirms your upload arrived, delete the videos from your laptop, including Camera Roll and the Recycle Bin.

10. Your privacy

- Your videos are labelled with your code, not your name.
- They are kept in a restricted folder that only the team can open, and they are never published.
- You can stop any recording, or ask for any clip to be deleted.
- You can withdraw at any time, without giving a reason, by telling the coordinator. Your recordings are then deleted within 30 days.
- The full terms are in the consent form you signed.

Quick card

Print this page and tick each item as you go.

	Session 1	Session 2	Session 3
Date			
Camera effects off, sticker on, framing checked	☐	☐	☐
Part A: 10 clips (2 s still, then 30 s, keep talking)			
1 `upright`	☐	☐	☐
2 `looking_away`	☐	☐	☐
3 `smile`	☐	☐	☐
4 `gestures`	☐	☐	☐
5 `desk_hands`	☐	☐	☐
6 `touching_face`	☐	☐	☐
7 `arms_crossed`	☐	☐	☐
8 `slouching`	☐	☐	☐
9 `reading_notes_held`	☐	☐	☐
10 `reading_notes_desk`	☐	☐	☐
Part B: 4 answers (2 s at the lens, then answer naturally)			
Answer 1 (q01 / q05 / q09)	☐	☐	☐
Answer 2 (q02 / q06 / q10)	☐	☐	☐
Answer 3 (q03 / q07 / q11)	☐	☐	☐
Answer 4 (q04 / q08 / q12)	☐	☐	☐
After recording			
All files renamed and in the session folder	☐	☐	☐
Checked before upload (section 8)	☐	☐	☐
Session details sent to the coordinator	☐	☐	☐
Uploaded to the shared folder	☐	☐	☐
Deleted from the laptop after the coordinator confirmed	☐	☐	☐